

English Playbook

English Language (Grammar · Vocabulary · Comprehension · Writing) + English Literature Toolkit

ICSE Class 6 · Full Book · Final Exam Ready

Play & Learn Notes · Independent study material, not affiliated with CISCE.
Chapter names and order can differ slightly between schools and publishers. Follow your school's exam syllabus.

How to use this playbook

Part	Chapters
Grammar	1. Sentences · 2. Nouns · 3. Pronouns · 4. Adjectives · 5. Verbs · 6. Tenses · 7. Subject–Verb Agreement · 8. Adverbs, Prepositions, Conjunctions · 9. Articles and Determiners · 10. Active and Passive Voice · 11. Direct and Indirect Speech · 12. Punctuation
Vocabulary	13. Synonyms, Antonyms, Homophones, Prefixes, Suffixes, Idioms
Reading and writing	14. Comprehension · 15. Composition (essays, stories) · 16. Letters · 17. Notice, Diary Entry, Email
Literature	18. Literature Toolkit (how to study any prose or poem in your textbook)

⭐ **Exam Tip: How the ICSE English paper usually looks (Class 6)**

English Language: composition (essay or story), a letter, a notice or email, comprehension and grammar. **English Literature:** prose, poetry and sometimes drama from your **school's textbook** (it differs between schools). Write neatly, **underline key words**, and always **read the question twice**.

1. Sentences

- A **sentence** is a group of words that makes **complete sense**. It begins with a **capital letter** and ends with **. ? or !**
- **Subject:** who or what the sentence is about. **Predicate:** what is said about the subject. *Riya* (subject) | *plays the guitar beautifully.* (predicate)

Kinds of sentences

Kind	Purpose	Example
Declarative (assertive)	Makes a statement	Mumbai is a busy city.
Interrogative	Asks a question	Where is the Gateway of India?
Imperative	Gives a command or request	Please close the door.
Exclamatory	Shows strong feeling	What a beautiful sunset!

- **Phrase:** a group of words **without** a subject and verb (*in the morning*). **Clause:** has a subject and verb (*when the bell rang*).
- **Simple sentence:** one clause. **Compound sentence:** two main clauses joined by *and, but, or, so*. **Complex sentence:** a main clause + a dependent clause (*I stayed home **because it was raining***.).

🧠 **Memory Trick**

Kinds of sentences: "DIIE = Dogs In India Eat": **D**eclarative, **I**nterrogative, **I**mperative, **E**xclamatory.

✏️ **Quick Check**

1. Identify the kind: "Shut the window."
2. Underline the subject: "The tall boy in the blue shirt won the race."
3. Is "under the old banyan tree" a phrase or a clause?
4. Join into a compound sentence: "It was raining. We went out."

2. Nouns

- A **noun** is a **naming word**: the name of a person, place, animal, thing or idea.

Kind	Meaning	Example
Proper	A particular name (capital letter)	Riya, Mumbai, the Ganga
Common	A general name	girl, city, river
Collective	A group as one	a **herd** of cattle, a **swarm** of bees, a **bunch** of keys, a **fleet** of ships, a **pride** of lions, a **flock** of sheep
Material	A substance	gold, wood, cotton
Abstract	A quality, feeling or idea (can't be touched)	honesty, joy, childhood, bravery

- **Countable nouns:** can be counted (book, chair). **Uncountable nouns:** can't be counted (water, advice, furniture).

Gender

Masculine	Feminine	Masculine	Feminine
king	queen	hero	heroine
lion	lioness	nephew	niece
horse	mare	bull	cow
actor	actress	monk	nun

- **Common gender:** teacher, friend, child. **Neuter gender:** table, book.

Number (plurals)

Rule	Examples
Most nouns: add **-s**	book → books
-s, -sh, -ch, -x, -o: add **-es**	bus → buses, box → boxes, potato → potatoes
Consonant + **y** → **-ies**	baby → babies (but boy → boys)
-f / -fe → **-ves**	leaf → leaves, knife → knives (but roof → roofs)
Irregular	man → men, child → children, mouse → mice, tooth → teeth, ox → oxen
Same form	sheep, deer, fish, aircraft

Possessive nouns

- Singular: add **'s** (the girl's bag). Plural ending in s: add only **'** (the girls' room). Irregular plural: **'s** (the children's park).

🧠 Memory Trick

Abstract = "Can't touch, can only feel": love, fear, honesty, freedom. **Collective nouns are a "team name"**: a **team** of players, a **class** of students, a **crowd** of people at Dadar station!

🎲 Play It in Class: Noun Basket

The teacher calls out a kind of noun ("Collective!"). The ball is passed around, and whoever holds it must give an example in 5 seconds ("a swarm of bees!"). If they repeat one or are too slow, they're out.

✏️ Quick Check

1. Pick out the abstract noun: "Her kindness won everyone's heart."
2. Write the collective noun: a _____ of fish, a _____ of stars.
3. Write the plurals: half, city, mango, ox.
4. Write the feminine of: nephew, tiger, host.

3. Pronouns

- A **pronoun** is used **in place of a noun** to avoid repeating it.

Kind	Examples
Personal	I, we, you, he, she, it, they (subject); me, us, him, her, them (object)
Possessive	mine, ours, yours, his, hers, theirs
Reflexive	myself, yourself, himself, herself, ourselves, themselves
Demonstrative	this, that, these, those
Interrogative	who, whom, whose, which, what
Relative	who, whom, whose, which, that (they join clauses)
Indefinite	someone, anybody, everyone, nothing, all, few

- **Subject vs object:** *She* helped *me*. (Not "Her helped I.")
- **Who** is for people, **which** is for things and animals, and **that** can be used for both.
- **Possessive pronouns never take an apostrophe:** its, yours, hers (**it's** = it is!).

🧠 **Memory Trick**

"It's" = "It is". "Its" = belongs to it. Test: can you say "it is"? Then use **it's**.

✏️ **Quick Check**

1. Fill in: The dog wagged _____ tail. (its / it's)
2. Correct: "Me and Riya went to the market."
3. Fill in a reflexive pronoun: "They enjoyed _____ at Juhu beach."
4. Use who or which: "The book _____ I bought is interesting."

4. Adjectives

- An **adjective** describes a noun or pronoun (it tells us **what kind, how many, which**).

Kind	Examples
Quality	brave, tall, beautiful
Quantity	some, much, little, enough
Number	one, first, few, many, several
Demonstrative	this, that, these, those
Interrogative	which, what, whose (followed by a noun)
Possessive	my, your, his, her, our, their

Degrees of comparison

Positive	Comparative	Superlative
tall	taller	tallest
big	bigger	biggest
happy	happier	happiest
beautiful	more beautiful	most beautiful
good	better	best
bad	worse	worst
many / much	more	most
little	less	least

- Use the comparative with **than** for **2 things**, and the superlative with **the** for **3 or more**. *Riya is taller **than** Aarav. She is **the tallest** in the class.*

Order of adjectives

Opinion → size → age → shape → colour → origin → material → purpose + noun *a lovely big old round red Indian wooden dining table*

> 🧠 **Memory Trick**
>
> **Order: "OSASCOMP"**, chanted like "Oh-So-A-Scomp!": Opinion, Size, Age, Shape, Colour, Origin, Material, Purpose.

> ✏️ **Quick Check**
>
> 1. Write the comparative and superlative of: thin, bad, careful.
> 2. Pick out the adjectives: "The little girl wore a pretty pink frock."
> 3. Correct: "He is more taller than his brother."
> 4. Arrange: (cotton / white / a / new) shirt.

5. Verbs

- A **verb** is an **action or being** word: run, eat, think, is, are, was.

Kinds of verbs

Kind	Meaning	Example
Transitive	Has an **object** (answers "what?" or "whom?")	She **reads** *a book*.
Intransitive	No object	The baby **sleeps**.
Auxiliary (helping)	Helps the main verb	She **is** dancing. They **have** finished.
Modal	Shows ability, permission, duty	can, could, may, might, must, should, will, would
Linking	Joins the subject to a description	She **seems** tired.

Finite and non-finite verbs

- **Finite:** changes with the subject and tense (*She **goes**, they **go**, she **went***).
- **Non-finite:** does **not** change: the **infinitive** (*to go*), the **gerund** (*Swimming is fun*) and the **participle** (*a **broken** cup*, the **running** boy).

Forms of verbs

Base	Past	Past participle
go	went	gone
eat	ate	eaten
write	wrote	written
begin	began	begun
bring	brought	brought
buy	bought	bought
catch	caught	caught
drink	drank	drunk
swim	swam	swum
take	took	taken

🧠 **Memory Trick**

Transitive = "Transfer": the action **transfers** to an object. *She kicked → the ball.* **Gerund = a verb + ing acting as a noun**: "**Reading** is my hobby."

🎲 Play It in Class: Verb Statues

The teacher calls a verb ("Swim! Write! Dance!"). Students freeze in that action. Then the teacher says "Past participle!" and students shout "Swum! Written! Danced!"

✏️ Quick Check

1. Transitive or intransitive? (a) The dog barked loudly. (b) Riya painted a picture.
2. Underline the gerund: "Cycling keeps you fit."
3. Write the past and past participle of: sing, choose, teach.
4. Pick out the modal verb: "You should wear a helmet."

6. Tenses

	Simple	Continuous	Perfect	Perfect Continuous
Present	I **play** / She **plays**	I **am playing**	I **have played**	I **have been playing**
Past	I **played**	I **was playing**	I **had played**	I **had been playing**
Future	I **will play**	I **will be playing**	I **will have played**	I **will have been playing**

When to use them

- **Simple present:** habits and facts. *The Sun **rises** in the east. She **goes** to school by bus.*
- **Present continuous:** happening now. *It **is raining** now.*
- **Present perfect:** just finished, or connected to now. *I **have finished** my homework.*
- **Simple past:** finished at a definite time. *We **visited** Elephanta Caves last year.*
- **Past continuous:** an action going on in the past. *I **was sleeping** when the phone rang.*
- **Past perfect:** the earlier of two past actions. *The train **had left** before we reached the station.*
- **Future:** *We **will go** to Lonavala tomorrow.*

Signal words

Tense	Signal words
Simple present	always, usually, every day, often
Present continuous	now, at present, look!, listen!
Present perfect	already, just, yet, ever, never, since, for
Simple past	yesterday, ago, last week, in 2020

- **Since** + a point in time (*since Monday*). **For** + a length of time (*for two hours*).

🧠 **Memory Trick**

Tense = time + form: "**Simple, Continuous, Perfect, Perfect Continuous**" × "**Present, Past, Future**" = **12 tenses**, a 3 × 4 grid. Draw the grid from memory before every exam!

🎲 **Play It in Class: Tense Time Machine**

Write a sentence on the board ("Riya eats a vada pav"). Students roll a die: 1–2 = past, 3–4 = present, 5–6 = future, then pick a card (simple, continuous, perfect, perfect continuous) and change the sentence. Correct = 1 point.

✏️ **Quick Check**

1. Change to the present continuous: "She writes a letter."
2. Fill in since or for: "I have lived in Mumbai _____ 2018."
3. Correct: "I have seen him yesterday."
4. Name the tense: "They had finished dinner before we arrived."

7. Subject–Verb Agreement

- **A singular subject takes a singular verb, and a plural subject takes a plural verb.** *The boy **runs**. The boys **run**.*

Rule	Example
Two subjects joined by **and** take a plural verb	Riya and Aarav **are** friends.
Each, every, everyone, nobody, either, neither take a singular verb	Each of the boys **has** a bag.
Either...or / neither...nor: the verb agrees with the **nearer** subject	Neither the teacher nor the students **were** late.
A collective noun acting as one unit takes a singular verb	The team **is** practising.
One of + plural noun takes a singular verb	One of my friends **lives** in Thane.
As well as / along with / with don't change the subject	The captain, as well as his players, **was** happy.
Some nouns look plural but are singular	The news **is** good. Mathematics **is** easy.
A plural-only noun takes a plural verb	My scissors **are** sharp. The trousers **are** new.

🧠 **Memory Trick**

"Each, Every, Either, Neither, One = ONE": always singular!

✏️ **Quick Check**

1. Choose: "One of the students (is / are) absent."
2. Choose: "Neither Riya nor her friends (was / were) present."
3. Choose: "Bread and butter (is / are) my breakfast." (one dish!)
4. Correct: "The news are very exciting."

8. Adverbs, Prepositions and Conjunctions

Adverbs (they describe a verb, an adjective or another adverb)

Kind	Answers	Examples
Manner	How?	slowly, bravely, carefully
Time	When?	now, yesterday, soon
Place	Where?	here, there, outside
Frequency	How often?	always, never, often
Degree	How much?	very, too, almost

Prepositions (they show the relation of a noun to another word)

Use	Prepositions	Example
Time	**at** (exact time), **on** (days and dates), **in** (months, years, parts of the day)	at 7 o'clock, on Monday, in May, in the morning
Place	at, in, on, under, between, among, beside, behind	in Mumbai, on the table
Movement	into, onto, towards, across, through	She jumped **into** the pool.

- **Between** for 2 things and **among** for more than 2. **Beside** means next to. **Besides** means in addition to.
- **Fixed prepositions:** good **at**, afraid **of**, interested **in**, angry **with** (a person), angry **at** (a thing), fond **of**, proud **of**, different **from**.

Conjunctions (joining words)

- **Coordinating:** and, but, or, so, yet (**FANBOYS**: for, and, nor, but, or, yet, so)
- **Subordinating:** because, although, when, while, if, unless, since, until
- **Correlative (in pairs):** either...or, neither...nor, not only...but also, both...and

🧠 **Memory Trick**

Time prepositions: "AT the clock, ON the calendar, IN the long time": at 5 pm, on Sunday, in 2026.

✏️ **Quick Check**

1. Fill in: The match starts _____ 4 pm _____ Saturday.
2. Fill in between or among: "Divide the sweets _____ the three children."
3. Join using although: "He was tired. He finished his homework."
4. Pick out the adverb: "She sings beautifully."

9. Articles and Determiners

- **A** comes before a **consonant sound**: a book, a **u**niform (the "yoo" sound), a **o**ne-rupee coin (the "wun" sound).
- **An** comes before a **vowel sound**: an apple, an **h**our (a silent h), an **M**LA (the "em" sound), an honest man.
- **The** is the definite article. Use it for specific things, unique things (the Sun), rivers, seas and mountain ranges (the Ganga, the Arabian Sea, the Himalayas), superlatives (the best), and musical instruments (play the guitar).
- **No article** before most names of people, cities and countries, meals (have lunch) or languages.
- **Determiners:** this, that, some, any, much, many, few, little, each, every
  - **Few / little** = hardly any (negative). **A few / a little** = some (positive).
  - **Much** goes with uncountable nouns (much water). **Many** goes with countable nouns (many books).

🧠 **Memory Trick**

Go by the SOUND, not the letter! "an hour" (the h is silent), "a university" (it sounds like "yoo").

✏️ **Quick Check**

1. Fill in a/an/the: _____ European, _____ umbrella, _____ Sun.
2. Fill in much or many: "How _____ students are present?"
3. Correct: "She plays a piano very well."
4. Fill in few or a few: "He has _____ friends, so he is happy."

10. Active and Passive Voice

- **Active voice:** the subject **does** the action. *Riya **wrote** a poem.*
- **Passive voice:** the subject **receives** the action. *A poem **was written** by Riya.*

Steps: (1) Swap the object and the subject. (2) Use the correct form of **be** + the **past participle**. (3) Add "**by**" + the doer (if needed).

Tense	Active	Passive
Simple present	She **cleans** the room.	The room **is cleaned** by her.
Present continuous	He **is painting** the wall.	The wall **is being painted** by him.
Simple past	They **built** a bridge.	A bridge **was built** by them.
Present perfect	I **have finished** the work.	The work **has been finished** by me.
Simple future	We **will plant** trees.	Trees **will be planted** by us.
Modal	You **must follow** the rules.	The rules **must be followed** by you.

- Pronoun changes: I → me, we → us, he → him, she → her, they → them.

🧠 **Memory Trick**

"Be + V3": every passive sentence has a form of **be** (is, am, are, was, were, been, being, be) + the **third form** of the verb.

✏️ **Quick Check**

1. Change to passive: "The cat drank the milk."
2. Change to passive: "Riya is singing a song."
3. Change to passive: "The BMC will repair the road."
4. Change to active: "The window was broken by Aarav."

11. Direct and Indirect (Reported) Speech

- **Direct:** the exact words, in quotation marks. *He said, "I am tired."*
- **Indirect:** reported in our own words. *He said that he was tired.*

Rules

1. **If the reporting verb is in the past** (said), change the tense **one step back**:

Direct	Indirect
am / is → was	are → were
simple present → simple past	will → would
present continuous → past continuous	can → could
simple past → past perfect	may → might
has / have → had	shall → should

2. **Change the pronouns** to suit the speaker.
3. **Change words of time and place:** now → then, today → that day, tomorrow → the next day, yesterday → the previous day, here → there, this → that, ago → before.
4. **Questions:** use **asked**. For yes/no questions use **if / whether**. For wh-questions use the **wh-word**. The sentence becomes a statement (no question mark). *She said to me, "Where do you live?" → She asked me where I lived.*
5. **Commands and requests:** use **told / ordered / requested** + **to** + the verb. *The teacher said, "Open your books." → The teacher told us to open our books.*
6. **Universal truths don't change tense:** *He said, "The Earth is round." → He said that the Earth **is** round.*

🧠 **Memory Trick**
"One step back in time": present → past, past → past perfect. Think of a **time machine going one step back**!

🎲 **Play It in Class: Gossip Reporter**
Student A whispers a sentence ("I am going to Juhu tomorrow"). Student B reports it to the class in indirect speech ("A said that she was going to Juhu the next day"). The class checks the changes.

✏️ **Quick Check**
1. Change to indirect: She said, "I like mangoes."
2. Change to indirect: He said to me, "Are you coming tomorrow?"
3. Change to indirect: The mother said, "Drink your milk."
4. Change to indirect: The teacher said, "The Sun rises in the east."

12. Punctuation

Mark	Use	Example
Capital letter	The start of a sentence, proper nouns, "I"	My friend Riya lives in Pune.
Full stop (.)	The end of a statement or command	We won the match.
Question mark (?)	The end of a direct question	Where are you going?
Exclamation mark (!)	Strong feeling	Hurray! We won!
Comma (,)	Lists, after "yes" or "no", before quotations, with addresses	I bought apples, mangoes and grapes.
Apostrophe (')	Possession and short forms	Riya's bag, don't, it's
Quotation marks (" ")	Exact spoken words	He said, "Come here."
Colon (:)	Before a list or explanation	You need three things: a pen, a book and a ruler.
Hyphen (-)	Joins words	well-known, twenty-one

✏️ **Quick Check**

Punctuate: **riya said to her mother can i go to the gateway of india with my friends on sunday**

13. Vocabulary Builder

Synonyms (same meaning)

Word	Synonym	Word	Synonym
big	large, huge	begin	start, commence
brave	courageous, bold	end	finish, conclude
happy	glad, joyful	quick	fast, rapid
sad	unhappy, sorrowful	help	assist, aid
beautiful	lovely, pretty	angry	furious, cross
clever	intelligent, smart	old	ancient, aged

Antonyms (opposite meaning)

Word	Antonym	Word	Antonym
ancient	modern	victory	defeat
generous	selfish, stingy	arrive	depart
polite	rude	increase	decrease
success	failure	import	export
strong	weak	possible	impossible
honest	dishonest	visible	invisible

Homophones (same sound, different meaning)

their (belongs to them) / **there** (a place) / **they're** (they are)	**to** / **too** (also, very) / **two** (2)	**hear** (with ears) / **here** (this place)
peace (calm) / **piece** (a part)	**write** / **right**	**weak** / **week**
flour (atta) / **flower**	**sea** / **see**	**son** / **sun**

Prefixes and suffixes

- **Prefixes (at the start):** un- (unhappy), dis- (dislike), im- (impossible), in- (incorrect), re- (rewrite), pre- (preview), mis- (misbehave)
- **Suffixes (at the end):** -ful (careful), -less (careless), -ness (kindness), -ment (enjoyment), -ly (quickly), -er/-or (teacher, actor)

Idioms

Idiom	Meaning
A piece of cake	Very easy
Break the ice	Start a conversation
Once in a blue moon	Very rarely
Hit the nail on the head	Say exactly the right thing
Under the weather	Feeling unwell
Let the cat out of the bag	Reveal a secret
Cry over spilt milk	Be sad about something that can't be changed
Burn the midnight oil	Study or work late at night

🎲 **Play It in Class: Word Wall Battle**

Two teams stand facing each other. The teacher says a word ("generous!"). The first team must give a synonym and the second team an antonym, within 5 seconds. Swap roles each round. Use the tables above!

✏️ **Quick Check**

1. Give the antonym: ancient, victory, arrive.
2. Fill in their/there/they're: "_____ going to _____ house over _____."
3. Add a prefix to make the opposite: honest, possible, agree.
4. What does "once in a blue moon" mean?

14. Comprehension (Reading Skills)

The 5-step method

1. **Read the passage once** for the general idea.
2. **Read the questions** carefully.
3. **Read the passage again** and **underline** the answers.
4. Answer in **complete sentences**, **in your own words** where asked.
5. For "word meaning" questions, find the word in the passage and read the **whole sentence** for context.

Types of questions

- **Factual:** the answer is directly in the passage.
- **Inference:** "Why do you think...?" Read between the lines.
- **Vocabulary:** find a word that means... / give the meaning of...
- **Title:** short (3–5 words) and covers the **main idea**.
- **True or false, MCQs, and summary (in a fixed number of words).**

> ⭐ **Exam Tip**
> Never copy whole paragraphs. Write **only what is asked**. In vocabulary questions, the word you give must be the **same part of speech** as the one asked for (a noun for a noun, a verb for a verb).

15. Composition (Essays and Stories)

Types

Type	Example topic	Tip
Descriptive	"A visit to Marine Drive", "My favourite festival: Ganesh Chaturthi"	Use the **5 senses** (see, hear, smell, taste, touch)
Narrative / story	"The day I got lost", "Complete the story beginning with..."	Beginning → problem → climax → ending + a moral or feeling
Argumentative / opinion	"Should mobile phones be allowed in school?"	Your opinion + 2–3 reasons + a conclusion
Personal experience	"My first day in a new school"	Feelings, details, what you learned
Picture composition	A picture is given	Describe it, or write a story connected to it

Structure (about 200–250 words in Class 6)

1. **Introduction** (2–3 lines): an interesting start, such as a question, a quote or a sound.
2. **Body** (2–3 paragraphs): one idea per paragraph, with details and examples.
3. **Conclusion** (2–3 lines): a feeling, a lesson or a message.

🧠 **Memory Trick**

A great opening = "Q-Q-S": start with a **Q**uestion ("Have you ever seen the sea glowing at night?"), a **Q**uote, or a **S**ound ("Ding! Ding! The school bell rang...").

📍 **Mumbai Connection: Topic ideas from our city**

"A ride in a Mumbai local train", "Ganpati Visarjan at Girgaon Chowpatty", "A rainy day in Mumbai", "A visit to the Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj Vastu Sangrahalaya (museum)", "The dabbawalas of Mumbai"

🎲 **Play It in Class: Story Chain**

The teacher says the first line: "It was a dark and stormy night in Mumbai..." Each student adds one sentence. The 10th student must give an ending. Then discuss: did the story have a beginning, a problem, a climax and an ending?

16. Letter Writing

Informal letter (to family and friends)

```
Sender's address
Date

Dear Grandma,                          ← Salutation

Para 1: Greeting + why you are writing
Para 2-3: Main news / details
Para 4: Closing lines (ask about them, send regards)

With love,                             ← Complimentary close
Riya                                   ← Your name
```

Formal letter (to the principal, an editor, an officer)

```
Sender's address
Date

The Principal / The Ward Officer       ← Receiver's designation
School name / Office name
Address

Subject: Request for … (one line)

Respected Sir/Madam,  (or Dear Sir/Madam,)

Para 1: Introduce yourself + reason for writing
Para 2: Details of the problem/request
Para 3: What you want done + thanks

Yours faithfully, (or Yours sincerely, if you know the name)
Riya Sharma
Class 6 B
```

	Informal	Formal
Language	Friendly, personal	Polite, to the point
Subject line	No	**Yes**
Close	With love / Yours lovingly / Your loving	**Yours faithfully / Yours sincerely**

> 🧠 **Memory Trick**
> **"F for Formal, F for Faithfully."** When you don't know the person's name (Sir/Madam), end with **Yours faithfully**.

📍 **Mumbai Connection: Practice topics**

(1) A letter to the **Ward Officer, BMC**, complaining about potholes and waterlogging on your road. (2) A letter to your cousin in Delhi describing the **Ganesh festival** in Mumbai. (3) A letter to your principal asking for a school trip to the **Nehru Science Centre**.

17. Notice, Diary Entry and Email

Notice (about 50 words, in a box)

```
            ABC SCHOOL, MUMBAI
                 NOTICE
Date: 15 November 2026
         INTER-HOUSE QUIZ COMPETITION
All students of Classes 6–8 are informed that an
inter-house quiz will be held on 25 November 2026
in the school auditorium at 10 am. Interested
students may give their names to the class teacher
by 20 November.
Riya Sharma
(School Captain)
```

- **Remember the 5 Ws: What, When, Where, Who** can take part, and **Whom** to contact.

Diary entry

```
Day, Date                          Time
Dear Diary,
(Write what happened + your feelings, in the first person, past tense)
(Name)
```

Email

To: … · **Subject:** … · **Salutation** · **Body** (short paragraphs) · **Closing** · **Name**

> ✏️ **Quick Check**
>
> 1. Write a notice for your school about a "Save Water" poster competition.
> 2. Write a diary entry about your first day at a new school.

18. English Literature Toolkit

The literature textbook **differs from school to school**. Use this toolkit for **every** prose lesson and poem in your book.

For every prose lesson, make a "Story Card"

Box	What to write
Title and author	
Setting	Where and when the story happens
Characters	Main characters + 2 qualities each, with one example
Plot in 5 lines	Beginning → problem → events → climax → ending
Theme or message	What the story teaches (honesty, friendship, courage...)
5 new words	With meanings
3 important quotes	Who said them, to whom, and why

For every poem, make a "Poem Card"

Box	What to write
Title and poet	
What the poem is about (3 lines)	
Mood or tone	Happy, sad, peaceful, patriotic, humorous...
Rhyme scheme	For example **aabb** or **abab** (mark the line endings with letters)
Poetic devices	See the table below, with one line from the poem as an example
Message	

Poetic devices

Device	Meaning	Example
Simile	A comparison using **like** or **as**	as brave **as** a lion; she sings **like** a nightingale
Metaphor	A direct comparison (no like or as)	Time **is** a thief.
Personification	Giving human qualities to non-living things	The wind **whispered**.
Alliteration	The same first sound repeated	**S**ally **s**ells **s**ea **s**hells
Onomatopoeia	Words that sound like their meaning	buzz, splash, tick-tock
Repetition	A word or line repeated for effect	"Miles to go before I sleep, and miles to go before I sleep"
Hyperbole	Exaggeration	I've told you **a million times**!

Answering "reference to context" (extract) questions

1. **Who** is speaking, to **whom**? 2. **Where** and **when**? 3. **What** does the line mean? 4. **Why** was it said? 5. **What happens next**?

Character sketch format

Introduction (who they are) → **3 qualities**, each with an **example from the text** → **conclusion** (what we learn from them).

> 🧠 **Memory Trick**
> **Simile vs metaphor: "Simile is Similar (with like or as). Metaphor is a Magic transformation (it *is* the thing)."**

> 🎲 **Play It in Class: Poetry Detective**
> Give each team a poem from your textbook. They must find one simile, one metaphor, one example of personification and one of alliteration, and work out the rhyme scheme, in 7 minutes. Each correct find scores a point!

> ⭐ **Exam Tip**
> **Teacher: please share the names of your school's prose lessons and poems.** Story Cards and Poem Cards can then be made for each one, using this toolkit, for the final exam.

Answer Key

Ch 1: (1) Imperative (2) The tall boy in the blue shirt (3) A phrase (4) It was raining, but we went out.

Ch 2: (1) kindness (2) school (shoal); galaxy (cluster) (3) halves, cities, mangoes, oxen (4) niece, tigress, hostess

Ch 3: (1) its (2) Riya and I went to the market. (3) themselves (4) which (or that)

Ch 4: (1) thinner, thinnest; worse, worst; more careful, most careful (2) little, pretty, pink (3) He is taller than his brother. (4) a new white cotton shirt

Ch 5: (1) (a) Intransitive (b) Transitive (2) Cycling (3) sang, sung; chose, chosen; taught, taught (4) should

Ch 6: (1) She is writing a letter. (2) since (3) I saw him yesterday. (4) Past perfect

Ch 7: (1) is (2) were (3) is (4) The news is very exciting.

Ch 8: (1) at, on (2) among (3) Although he was tired, he finished his homework. (4) beautifully

Ch 9: (1) a European, an umbrella, the Sun (2) many (3) She plays the piano very well. (4) a few

Ch 10: (1) The milk was drunk by the cat. (2) A song is being sung by Riya. (3) The road will be repaired by the BMC. (4) Aarav broke the window.

Ch 11: (1) She said that she liked mangoes. (2) He asked me if I was coming the next day. (3) The mother told the child to drink his/her milk. (4) The teacher said that the Sun rises in the east.

Ch 12: Riya said to her mother, "Can I go to the Gateway of India with my friends on Sunday?"

Ch 13: (1) modern, defeat, depart (2) They're, their, there (3) dishonest, impossible, disagree (4) Very rarely

Ch 17: Check the format: a box, the school name, NOTICE, the date, a heading, the 5 Ws, and a name and designation. For the diary entry: the day, date and time, "Dear Diary", feelings, and the first person.